



March 15, 2025

Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP)
Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National
Coordination Office (NCO)
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314, USA
Email: [REDACTED]

Subject: Response to Request for Information on the AI Action Plan

Dear OSTP and NITRD NCO,

The Alliance for Digital Innovation (ADI) appreciates the opportunity to provide input on the development of the AI Action Plan, as directed by Executive Order 14179, *Removing Barriers to American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence*. ADI is a non-partisan alliance that advocates for the removal of institutional and bureaucratic barriers to the operation of a modern digital government. Our members provide key critical technologies to the federal government, including cloud infrastructure, digital identity solutions, human resources software, quantum computing, digital services, and a range of sophisticated cybersecurity tools and services. We support the adoption of innovative commercial technologies by the Federal Government.

ADI offers the following recommendations to sustain and enhance America's AI leadership.

1. Implement a Risk-Based Approach to AI Governance

Effective AI governance should focus on the specific risks associated with various AI applications from development through deployment. ADI advocates for a framework that:

- **Identifies High-Risk AI Applications:** Concentrate regulatory efforts on AI systems that have a significant legal or safety impact on individuals, thereby avoiding unnecessary constraints on low-risk, enterprise-level AI uses, such as cybersecurity measures.
- **Exempts Routine Enterprise Functions:** Explicitly exclude AI applications in cybersecurity, network management, software development on low-risk environments, and data storage from high-risk classifications to ensure these critical functions remain agile and effective.

2. Enhance AI Procurement Processes

To promote the integration of advanced AI technologies in government operations, procurement processes should be modernized to:

- **Increase Micro-Purchase and Simplified Acquisition Thresholds:** Raising these thresholds enables agencies to swiftly acquire innovative AI solutions, fostering a more competitive and flexible procurement environment.
- **Encourage Engagement with Emerging Tech Providers:** Simplifying procurement procedures allows smaller, innovative companies to contribute AI solutions, enriching the government's technological capabilities.

3. Prioritize AI in Cybersecurity

AI plays a pivotal role in enhancing cybersecurity across government networks. Policies should:

- **Support AI-Driven Cyber Defense Mechanisms:** Utilize AI to monitor and defend information networks, providing real-time visibility and rapid incident response to protect against sophisticated cyber threats. Additionally, the administration should prioritize investment in technology that will defend against next-generation cyber-attacks, including sophisticated attacks powered by generative AI.
- **Adopt Security-Forward Postures:** Implement use-case-specific policies that impose appropriate requirements on developers and deployers of high-risk AI systems, while exempting routine enterprise IT functions from unnecessary constraints.

4. Work with Industry to Build Security into AI

As AI is consumed by government departments and agencies, the administration should work with industry to build security into AI technology adopted and utilized across government networks. Policies should:

- **Work with Industry on Standards and Best Practices:** As the United States continues to lead the way on AI development and adoption, the administration should work with industry to develop and implement secure practices for AI technology. Additionally, the administration should leverage existing compliance mechanisms to drive the adoption of those practices across AI technology used by departments and agencies.
- **Drive Standards Adoption:** The administration should lead the discussion on adoption of common security practices for AI technology. The administration can leverage the work of the National Institute of Standards and Technology to underpin industry-led security best practices and associated compliance mechanisms to ensure a more resilient AI ecosystem.

5. Foster Collaboration Between Government and Industry

A robust partnership between the public and private sectors is essential for AI advancement. To strengthen this collaboration:

- **Establish Public-Private Partnerships:** Create initiatives that bring together government agencies and industry leaders to co-develop AI solutions addressing national challenges.

- **Facilitate Knowledge Exchange:** Organize forums and workshops where government and industry stakeholders can share best practices, emerging trends, and lessons learned in AI adoption.

6. Invest in AI Workforce Development

Building a skilled workforce is critical to sustaining AI leadership. Efforts should include:

- **Educational Programs and Training:** Develop curricula and certification programs to equip current and future workers with AI competencies and hands-on experiences.
- **Reskilling and Upskilling Initiatives:** Provide opportunities for existing employees to acquire AI-related skills, ensuring they can adapt to technological advancements.

7. Invest in Good Government Data Practices

Government agencies have robust repositories of primary data stores that can power and underpin AI models that governments use to deliver services to citizens and deliver efficient mission outcomes. Government efforts should include:

- **Policies that drive good data practices:** Agencies should review their primary data to make sure the data sets are clean, organized, appropriately tagged and marked, and formatted for digital use. This includes migrating paper-based data stores to digital formats. Congress should consider updating or amending the Federal Data Strategy and Evidence Acts to include AI considerations around data management.
- **Programs that leverage government data:** As agencies adopt commercial, cloud-based AI technology, agency leaders should prioritize leveraging existing government data to train government AI models to ensure effective and efficient service and mission delivery. Government can develop standard service level agreements that ensure appropriate privacy and security protections for both primary and derived data.

Conclusion

By adopting a risk-based approach to AI governance, modernizing procurement processes, prioritizing AI in cybersecurity, fostering public-private collaboration, and investing in workforce development, the United States can reinforce its position as a global leader in artificial intelligence. ADI stands ready to support these efforts and collaborate with policymakers to achieve these objectives.

The Alliance for Digital Innovation appreciates the opportunity to submit these comments for your consideration. As OSTP continues to develop policies and strategies to ensure the responsible procurement of AI by federal agencies, ADI stands ready to provide any additional insight or feedback. Thank you again for the opportunity to engage on such an important topic.

Sincerely,

Alliance for Digital Innovation